

**Disable A Browser Section**

Right-click on any browser title and a list of visible browsers will show up. You can use this list to disable or re-enable any browsers available.

**Search Intelligently Using Google-like Syntax**

You can get precise search results by using Google-like search syntax. For example, if you key in `artist:shakira` in the search box, you'll get everything that has shakira as the artist. You can also enclose the expression in double quotes so that you can use spaces. You can also chain expressions (as in `artist:shakira album: "Oral Fixation"`) to find an album containing "Oral Fixation" by the artist Shakira.

Each tag has its own operator, so you can even search for

```
bitrate:192
comments:"Immersive score"
type:ogg
score:92
track:5
genre:classical
composer:"Beethoven"
year:1973
```

Boolean operators can be used to refine your searches. The `'-'` operator negates the expression.

**Output To The Desired Sound Device**

If you're using ALSA drivers, you can output the audio to a specific sound device with xine. Set up a `~/.asoundrc` (user-only) or `/etc/asound.conf` (system-wide) file that aliases your hardware devices, then insert that alias in the "device used for stereo output:" box in the xine-engine configuration tab. Alternatively, you can directly enter the alsa device (`hw:0,0` or `hw:1,0` and so on). If you choose this latter method, be aware that ALSA's corresponding plugfoo (e.g. `plughw:0,0` or `plughw:1,0` and so on) routing through alsa-lib is much preferred.

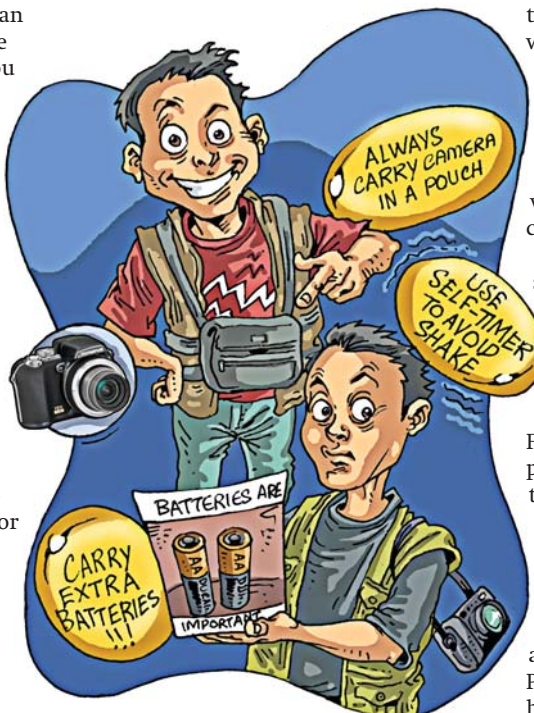
Here is an example of `~/.asoundrc` for a machine that has an onboard Intel AC97 codec and a usb-audio device:

```
pcm.intel8x0 {
    type plug
    slave.pcm "hw:0"
}
ctl.intel8x0 {
    type hw
    card 0
}
pcm.usb-audio {
    type plug
    slave.pcm "hw:1"
}
ctl.usb-audio {
```

```
type hw
card 1
}
```

Now enter `usb-audio` in the xine-engine setup screen, and the output should go to the usb-audio device (with alsa-lib properly handling sample rate conversion, channels, and so on).

DIGITAL CAMERAS



In this issue, we've already told you about the best cameras your money can buy; now we give you some suggestions on how to use it right. Here are some tips that can come handy when you're out shooting.

**Get Yourself A Tripod**

Cumbersome as it may seem to set up, a tripod is great for getting rid of the unavoidable hand shake that is the root cause of blur in your photos. It's also not always possible to place your camera in a suitable position in the environment you may be in. Tripods allow you place your camera in pretty much any position, and they aren't overly expensive either. You can find light, portable tripods for around Rs 1,500. It's possible to get compact tripods that can be folded into a package around a foot in length that can easily fit into a backpack.

**Avoid The Flash**

One of the worst possible things one can do with a camera is to use the flash. Flashes on a camera wipe out

most detail and wash out most colour in the photograph. Digital cameras don't have as strong flashes as it is, and most of them don't have provision for more powerful ones—so most of the time your camera flash isn't going to brighten the scene anyway.

To clarify: the flash is effective only at short ranges, and in that range, it tends to destroy detail and colour; at longer ranges, it's pretty useless.

Now if you use the flash, you'll tend to get an imbalanced shot—as in, a shot where only the focused-on object is clear. It's a better idea to use a longer exposure by decreasing the shutter speed. It's preferable to use a tripod to prevent shake in this case, as you can get realistic colours and lighting without the uneven lighting conditions given by the flash.

If a flash must be used, then make sure you are standing away from the subject to prevent it getting washed out by the flash.

**Using Flash To Remove Shadows**

Flashes may be bad in general in indoor photographs or very dark places, but they are a boon in outdoor photography where you have an object or a person facing the camera with the sun or a light source in the background. The flash allows you to get some light to the face of the object and helps avoid complete blackout. Places where this is useful is when you have someone wearing a cap or standing under a roof in the open, or if it's late afternoon or morning with the sun in the background.

**Use A Lens Hood**

In some of the more advanced digital cameras, the camera manufacturer may provide a lens hood that attaches to the front of the lens. While this will make the camera more bulky, it helps in getting good photos without lens flare—where one area of the photo reflects too much light—in well-lit-up areas. If your camera cannot have a lens hood, then the other possible way to get rid of lens flare could be to use a UV filter. The UV also helps in keeping your lens safe from dust.

The hood becomes an obstacle in many cases where you use a flash. The flash can get obstructed by the hood and you might end up with underexposed photos—or you may find a prominent shadow of the hood in the photo.

If the hood must be used, a way around this obstacle is to use some amount of zoom in the photo.